

99. Crop and Flower Shop Pools & Daily Friendship Farming

Integrated English Draft — RF4SP and RF5 practical guide with evidence boundaries

Scope: This appendix is not an equipment-inheritance specification. It connects a shop-display candidate-pool question with practical long-term friendship farming in Rune Factory 4 Special and Rune Factory 5.

99-1. Why shop-display pools matter

Some crops and flowers enter shop display pools after shipment. Over a long playthrough, adding rarely used products may increase the number of possible shop items and could reduce the chance that a desired crop appears. This matters for routes that depend on stable access to ingredients for Turnip Heaven, Gold Juice, Tropical-Run, Relax Tea, or repeated resident gifts.

Evidence boundary: The relationship between pool size and actual display probability has not been tested sufficiently. The similarity to the Candidate Count Model is structural only; it does not show that shops use the same mechanism as equipment inheritance.

99-2. Clerk-change observation and unresolved hypothesis

In earlier RF4SP play, the author remembers shop contents changing after the clerk changed within what appeared to be the same day and load state. The remembered cases involved the General Store (Doug / Blossom), Flower Shop (Illuminata / Amber), and Clinic (Jones / Nancy). No sufficient record or controlled reproduction test is currently preserved.

RF5 testing under comparable conditions has not confirmed a clerk-change reroll.

Hypothesis: If RF4SP performs an independent product selection for each clerk, days with both clerks present may provide multiple effective selection opportunities. Relax Tea Leaves could then have up to four opportunities per load across the Flower Shop and Clinic. This remains an unverified hypothesis.

99-3. Practical operating principle

- Prioritize shipping crops and flowers that support frequently repeated gifts or cooking routes.
- Use inexpensive handmade gifts where sustainable; handmade items receive a friendship bonus.

- Check the friendship gauge after each gift when testing daily gain, especially at low friendship levels.
- Treat Normal, Favorite, and Loved gifts as separate observed daily opportunities in the author's environment, not as proof of internal counters.
- Choose a route that can be repeated every day; sustainable routines often outperform theoretically optimal but burdensome routes.

Using this style of long-term routine, the author reached friendship level 10 with all residents around autumn of Year 1 in both RF4SP and RF5. This is a personal observation, not a guaranteed result; playtime, story progress, gift selection, daily actions, Ventuswill's absence, and forced time progression can all affect the outcome.

99-4. Rune Factory 4 Special Daily Friendship Farming Guide

RF4SP Daily Friendship Farming Guide

Daily Farming Tip

This guide is designed around daily friendship farming, not just a single favorite gift.

In Rune Factory 4 Special, Normal, Favorite, and Loved gifts contribute to daily friendship separately. Combining inexpensive gifts from different categories with handmade gifts can greatly improve long-term friendship efficiency.

Handmade gifts receive a friendship bonus, so planning your routine around easy recipes and shared ingredients can reduce both time and material costs.

Arthur's rotating shop may occasionally sell Milk, Eggs, and Honey in bulk.

When this happens, several efficient daily gift routes become much easier to maintain.

Daily Strategy

- Give one Loved Gift.
- Give one easy handmade Liked Gift.
- Repeat every day.

Handmade gifts generally provide more Friendship Points than raw ingredients thanks to the handmade gift bonus.

Daily Friendship Farming Cheat Sheet

Character	♥ Loved Gift	Favorite Gift	Daily Gift	Notes
Margaret	Prelude to Love / Pineapple Juice	Hot Chocolate	Pickled Turnip / Rice Ball / Turnip Seeds	Easy batch-cooking route.
Kohaku	Gold Juice / Mixed au Lait	Any Juice	Pickled Turnip / Rice Ball / Turnip Seeds	Mixed au Lait is usually more practical than Gold Juice.
Forte	Chocolate Cake / Hot Pot / Omelet Rice	Boiled Egg / Rolled Omelet	Pickled Turnip / Rice Ball / Turnip Seeds	Hot Pot is powerful but preparation-heavy.
Dolce	Pudding	Hot Chocolate /	Pickled Turnip / Rice	Hot Chocolate benefits from the

		Medicine	Ball / Turnip Seeds	handmade bonus.
Xiao Pai	Crystal Flowers / Gold Turnip Flower	Chinese Bun	Pickled Turnip / Rice Ball / Turnip Seeds	Chinese Buns are cheap and sustainable.
Clorica	Apple Pie	Apple Juice / Baked Apple	Pickled Turnip / Rice Ball / Turnip Seeds	Efficient use of Apples.
Vishnal	Curry Rice / Dry Curry	Chinese Bun	Rice Ball / Turnip Seeds	Turnips are disliked, but Turnip Seeds are accepted.
Dylas	Milk Porridge	Any Sashimi	Pickled Turnip / Rice Ball / Turnip Seeds	Sashimi avoids Milk consumption.
Arthur	Salmon Rice Ball	Pickled Turnip / Rice Ball	Bread / Turnip Seeds	Cheap and easy to maintain.
Kiel	Chocolate Cake / Hot Pot / Ambrosia's Thorns	Hot Chocolate	Pickled Turnip / Rice Ball / Turnip Seeds	Ambrosia's Thorns are easy Boss Drops.
Doug	Tempura Bowl	Rice Ball	Pickled Turnip / Turnip Seeds	Rice-based route.
Leon	Grilled Poison Trout / Grilled Lamp Squid	Any Grilled Fish	Pickled Turnip / Rice Ball / Turnip Seeds	Common fish work well for daily gifting.
Ventuswill	Hotcake	Easy-to-Grow Vegetables	Pickled Turnip / Rice Ball / Turnip Seeds	Great use of surplus crops.
Volkanon	☕ Relax Tea	Hot Chocolate	Pickled Turnip / Rice Ball / Turnip Seeds	Prepare Relax Tea ingredients in advance.
Jones	Fried Rice	Porridge / Rice Ball	Pickled Turnip / Turnip Seeds	Extremely low-cost route.

Nancy	Stew	Pudding	Pickled Turnip / Rice Ball / Turnip Seeds	Excellent Milk and Egg synergy.
Illuminata	Relax Tea Leaves	Hot Chocolate	Pickled Turnip / Rice Ball / Turnip Seeds	One batch supports both Illuminata and Volkanon.
Lin Fa	Milk Porridge	Porridge / Rice Ball	Pickled Turnip / Turnip Seeds	Efficient Rice- based route.
Porcoline	Fresh Vegetables	Pickled Turnip / Rice Ball	Scrap Metal / Turnip Seeds	Extremely easy to maintain.
Blossom	Risotto	Porridge	Pickled Turnip / Rice Ball / Turnip Seeds	Cheap and sustainable.
Bado	Egg Bowl	Rice Ball	Pickled Turnip / Turnip Seeds	Rice Balls are usually cheaper.

Why Turnip Seeds?

Turnip Seeds do not receive the handmade gift bonus.

However, they stack efficiently, require no cooking, and can also be given to Vishnal.

For long-term friendship farming, they are often the simplest and most inventory-efficient option.

Daily Farming Note

♥ Loved Gifts and Favorite Gifts should be combined with Daily Gifts whenever possible to maximize long-term friendship gains.

Daily Gifts are practical low-cost gifts recommended for everyday friendship farming. They are not necessarily classified as "Normal Gifts" by the game.

Guest Characters

Guest characters are excluded from this guide.

Friendship gain from gifts does not function normally for guest characters.

Conversation events are generally more important than gifting.

Ingredient Priority Guide

Tier	Ingredient	Why It Matters
S	Rice	Supports the largest number of daily friendship routes.
S	Eggs	Shared by many handmade gifts and loved gifts.
S	Milk	Core ingredient for several efficient friendship routes.
A	Flour	Used in Chinese Buns, Cakes, Hotcakes, and more.
A	Chocolate	One ingredient supports multiple residents through Hot Chocolate and Cakes.
A	Apples	Supports several Clorica routes with minimal effort.
B	Honey	Important for Hotcakes, Relax Tea, and Mixed au Lait.
B	Bamboo Shoot	Enables efficient Chinese Bun routes.
B	Leek	Used by both Hot Pot and Relax Tea routes.
B	Colored Grass	Required for Relax Tea production.
EX	Gold Crops & Gold Turnip Flower	Powerful but expensive endgame friendship options.

Shopping Priorities

Always worth stockpiling

Rice

Eggs

Milk

Buy when available

Honey

Bamboo Shoot

Leek

Pink Melon

Colored Grass

Shared Ingredient Routes

Ingredient	Recipes	Recipients
Rice	Rice Ball, Porridge, Milk Porridge	Arthur, Doug, Jones, Lin Fa, Bado, Dylas, Blossom
Chocolate	Hot Chocolate, Chocolate Cake	Margaret, Dolce, Kiel, Volkanon, Illuminata
Eggs	Boiled Egg, Rolled Omelet, Pudding	Forte, Dolce, Nancy
Apples	Apple Juice, Baked Apple, Apple Pie	Clorica
Flour	Chinese Bun, Chocolate Cake, Apple Pie	Vishnal, Xiao Pai, Forte, Kiel, Clorica

Recommended Daily Production Routes

Beginner Route

Rice Ball

Porridge

Pickled Turnip

Simple, cheap, and sustainable.

Handmade Bonus Route

Hot Chocolate

Chinese Bun

Sashimi

Good friendship gains with relatively low effort.

Premium Route

Pudding

Apple Pie

Relax Tea

Higher preparation cost but excellent rewards.

Practical Friendship Farming Tips

There is no single best gift route.

A sustainable route is usually better than an optimal route that is difficult to maintain.

Choose gift routes based on:

- Available ingredients
- Arthur's rotating stock
- Cooking skill level
- Personal preference

The best route is the one you can continue every day.

Stock Management Tips

Rune Factory 4 Special shops have relatively small inventory pools.

When rare ingredients appear, consider purchasing extra stock in advance rather than waiting for the next appearance.

Examples:

- Leek
- Pink Melon
- Honey
- Bamboo Shoot
- Colored Grass

Many players prefer keeping 20–30 units of these ingredients in storage to avoid future shortages.

For ingredients used across multiple daily friendship routes, bulk purchases are often worthwhile.

Recommended Bulk Purchases:

- Rice (100+)
- Milk
- Eggs

Arthur's rotating stock can occasionally provide large quantities of Milk, Eggs, and Honey, making it an excellent opportunity to build reserves for future friendship farming.

99-5. Rune Factory 5 Daily Friendship Farming Guide

RF5 Daily Friendship Farming Guide

Daily Farming Tip

This guide is designed around daily friendship farming, not just favorite gifts.

In Rune Factory 5, Normal, Favorite, and Loved gifts contribute to daily friendship separately. Combining inexpensive gifts from different categories, together with shared ingredients and batch cooking, can greatly improve long-term friendship efficiency.

① Daily Gift Farming Guide

Base Material	Make	Qty	Recipients
Rice	Porridge	×3	Scarlett, Simone, Livia
	Grilled Rice Ball	×2	Ryker, Misasagi
	Rice Ball	×2	Elsje, Doug
Flour	Toast	×2	Reinhard★, Terry
	Bread	×1	Beatrice
	Udon	×1	Lucas
Chocolate	Hot Chocolate	×3	Priscilla, Hina, Margaret
Dumpling Flour	Dumpling	×2	Randolph, Murakumo
Strawberry	Strawberry Jam	×2	Beatrice★, Radea
Orange	Orange Juice	×1	Julian
Fish	Poison Trout Sashimi	×1	Ludmila
	Smelt (recommended)	×2	Fuuka, Lucy
Minerals	Ore	×1	Martin

★ = Favorite Gift

Optional Daily Alternatives

Gift	Recipient(s)	Notes
Fruit (Early Game)	Cecil	Easy daily option before late-game crafting becomes available.
Aquamarine Brooch (Late Game)	Cecil	Crafted gifts receive the handmade bonus, making this an excellent long-term option once Platinum and Aquamarine are

Grilled Smelt / Grilled Yamame	Darroch	easily obtainable. Requires Sour Drop, so preparing several at once is recommended.
Grilled Pacific Saury	Heinz	Requires Sour Drop, so preparing several at once is recommended.
Grape Bread	Yuki	Simple alternative if you don't want to make Butter Rolls.

Special Loved Gifts

Gift	Qty	Recipient(s)	Notes
Emerald	×1	Fuuka★	Loved mineral gift
Orichalcum (Emerald also works)	×1	Darroch★	Emerald is a cheaper alternative
Skull Crystal	×1	Heinz★	
Thunderbird Feather / Devil Horn / Fairy Elixir	×1	Palmo★	Any of these works
Dragon Fang	×1	Radea★	
Grilled Poison Trout	×1	Ludmila★	Requires Sour Drop during cooking.
Tempura	×2	Scarlett★, Misasagi★	Shared recipe
Tempura Bowl	×1	Doug★	
Curry Rice	×1	Julian★	
Curry Bun	×1	Randolph★	
Curry Udon	×1	Lucas★	
Salmon Rice Ball	×1	Lucy★	Requires Salted Salmon (Salmon + Sour Drop).
Butter Roll	×1	Yuki★	
Sandwich	×1	Simone★	
Fruit Sandwich	×2	Martin★, Cecil★	Shared recipe
Steamed Chocolate Cake	×1	Priscilla★	
Hotcake	×1	Elsje★	
Tosa Dish	×1	Murakumo★	Requires Sour Drop

			during cooking.
Pumpkin Pudding	×1	Livia★	
Fruit au Lait	×1	Hina★	
Prelude to Love / Pineapple Juice	×1	Margaret★	Either recipe works
Croquette / Ice Cream	×1	Ryker★	Choose based on your Egg or Milk cooking route
Earth Pendant	×1	Terry★	See Practical Loved Gift Tips

Daily Ingredient Requirements

(for the recipes above)

Ingredient	Qty	Used For
Milk	7–8	Butter, Butter Roll, Hotcake, Pumpkin Pudding, Fruit au Lait, Ice Cream route, Steamed Chocolate Cake
Eggs	9–10	Tempura ×3, Sandwich, Hotcake, Croquette route, Pumpkin Pudding, Butter Roll, Steamed Chocolate Cake
Sweet Powder	0–1	Ice Cream route
Sour Drop	5	Grilled Poison Trout, Grilled Smelt/Yamame, Grilled Pacific Saury, Salted Salmon, Tosa Dish
Rice	13	Porridge ×3, Rice Ball ×4, Grilled Rice Ball ×2, Curry Rice ×3, Tempura Bowl, Salmon Rice Ball
Flour	11	Toast ×2, Bread ×5, Udon, Curry Bun, Curry Udon, Butter Roll, Hotcake, Tempura ×3, Steamed Chocolate Cake
Carrot	3	Curry Rice ×3
Potato	3–4	Curry Rice ×3 / +1 if using Croquette for Ryker
Oil	3–4	Tempura ×3 / +1 if using Croquette for Ryker

Shrimp	3	Tempura ×3
Strawberry	4–5	Strawberry Jam ×2, Fruit Sandwich ×2, Prelude to Love route
Pink Melon	0–1	Prelude to Love route
Pineapple	0–1	Pineapple Juice route
Chocolate	1-4	Steamed Chocolate Cake only / + Hot Chocolate ×3
Grape	1	Grape Bread route
Cucumber	1	Sandwich
Salmon	1	Salted Salmon
Poison Trout	2	Grilled Poison Trout, Poison Trout Sashimi
Smelt/Yamame	1	Darroch alternative
Pacific Saury	1	Heinz alternative
Bonito	1	Tosa Dish
Any Fish (recommended: Smelt)	2	Lucy, Fuuka

- This is an example daily farming route.
- Ingredient totals may vary depending on your selected gift route.
- The higher Milk and Egg values apply when making Ice Cream instead of Croquette for Ryker.
- Margaret's route uses either Prelude to Love or Pineapple Juice (not both).

Sour Drop is required for:

- Grilled Poison Trout
- Grilled Smelt / Grilled Yamame
- Grilled Pacific Saury
- Salted Salmon (for Salmon Rice Ball)
- Tosa Dish

Batch Cooking Guide

Base Material

Rice

Flour

Batch Production Route

Rice Ball → Grilled Rice Ball / Porridge / Salmon Rice Ball / Tempura Bowl

Bread → Toast / Sandwich / Fruit Sandwich / Butter Roll

Chocolate	Hot Chocolate → Steamed Chocolate Cake
Milk	Butter → Butter Roll / Hotcake / Pumpkin Pudding / Fruit au Lait / Ice Cream
Eggs	Tempura / Sandwich / Hotcake / Croquette / Pumpkin Pudding / Butter Roll
Strawberry	Strawberry Jam → Fruit Sandwich / Prelude to Love
Orange	Orange Juice
Curry	Curry Rice → Curry Udon
Tempura	Tempura → Tempura Bowl

Cook With Someone Recommendations

Rune Factory 5 supports Cook With Someone (×2).

Preparing commonly used intermediate ingredients in advance can save both materials and cooking time.

Recipe	Prep Time	Material Savings	Notes
Rice Ball	★★★	★☆☆	Used frequently for daily gifts. Large quantities are recommended.
Bread	★★★	★★☆	Used for Toast, Sandwiches, and Fruit Sandwiches. One of the most versatile intermediate ingredients.
Tempura	★★★	★★☆	Shared recipe for Scarlett★ and Misasagi★. Also used for Tempura Bowls.
Curry	★★★	★★☆	Used for Curry Udon and Curry Buns. Preparing Curry last minimizes ingredient consumption and RP cost.
Salted Salmon	★★★	★★☆	Requires Salmon + Sour Drop. Preparing several in advance makes Salmon Rice Balls much easier to cook.
Butter Roll	★★☆	★★★★	Extremely Milk and Egg

			intensive. One of the best Cook With Someone targets.
Hotcake	★★☆	★★★	Uses both Milk and Eggs. Efficient when prepared in batches.
Pumpkin Pudding	★★☆	★★★	Uses both Milk and Eggs. Important Loved Gift recipe.
Steamed Chocolate Cake	★★☆	★★★	Uses both Milk and Eggs. Supports the Chocolate Route and Priscilla★.

Practical Loved Gift Tips

Aquamarine Brooch

Platinum and Aquamarine ore veins are located near the entrance of Thunderous Wastes Floor 1.

Repeated mining makes this Loved Gift surprisingly practical for long-term farming.

Earth Pendant

After one shop upgrade:

- Earth Crystal can be purchased from the Crystal Shop.
- Gold can be purchased from the Blacksmith.

Despite being a crafted accessory, it is surprisingly practical for long-term friendship farming.

Bottom

These are practical long-term Loved Gift options that are often overlooked.

Notes

- Optimized for daily friendship farming.
- Plan your daily gifts around shared ingredients whenever possible.
- Handmade dishes are generally more efficient than raw ingredients.
- Rune Factory 5 supports Cook With Someone (×2).
- Shared ingredients and intermediate recipes can significantly reduce material costs and cooking time.
- Normal, Favorite, and Loved gifts are tracked separately for daily friendship gains. Combining inexpensive gifts from different categories can significantly improve long-term friendship efficiency.

99-6. Interpretation and use boundary

The shop-pool question and the daily friendship guides are joined here because ingredient availability affects the sustainability of repeated gift routes. They remain different evidence layers: the guides are practical operating examples, while shop-pool size, clerk-specific selection, and selection independence remain unresolved research questions.

- Game boundary: RF4SP clerk-change observations must not be transferred to RF5.
- Evidence boundary: gauge movement after gifts is an observable result; the internal friendship-processing mechanism remains unknown.
- Terminology boundary: the guide labels are practical categories for route planning and should not be treated as an exhaustive internal classification.
- Outcome boundary: the author's Year-1 results do not guarantee the same schedule for other players.